

The Thoughtful Review

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FRONT PAGE

How to Become Ryuk from Death Note for Halloween

Nelson Aguilar · WonderHowTo

Ryuk, the popular anime death god character from Death Note, has instilled fear into many. Just from the live-action movie version, his horror penetrates through the screen. I mean, c'mon, just look at this horrifying beast: Death Note (2006) – Warner Bros. Pictures As horrifying as Ryuk may be, he is a lovable character and is especially admired in the cosplay world. Now, you can become Ryuk with the help of various YouTubers, depending on how you want to go about your costume. You can go the entire makeup route with all the accessories you'll need to become Ryuk this Halloween (or whenever), make a mask, and so on. The end result is amazing and doesn't cost a boatload of cash. Here is a comparison of Ryuk the character and the costume: Takeshi Obata/Wikipediaellimacs sfx makeup – YouTubePretty similar right?

All you need to finish the costume is an apple, and you're ...more

FEATURES

French Holiday Recipes

Anne Elder · Chocolate & Zucchini

Buy Clotilde's latest book, *The French Market Cookbook* !

Christmas is just a few days away (not to stress you out or anything) and I was shocked to realize that, in fourteen years of *Chocolate & Zucchini*, I have never offered an actual post outlining how to host a French holiday meal .

So whether you're seeking to add a little Frenchness to your holiday celebrations, attending your first bona fide French holiday meal this year, or even hosting one (gah!), let me break things down for you, and suggest some winning French holiday recipes .

Christmas and the New Year

French families get together for a Christmas Eve dinner (*le réveillon de Noël*), and often there's a second meal for Christmas Day lunch (not breakfast or brunch), either with the same cast or with a different part of the family.

Christmas is largely celebrated in the home; most restaurants are closed that night for staff members to celebrate with their own family. It is considered an intimate occasion reserved for family members and close family friends, so if you are a guest from outside the family, it's a big deal. Presents are opened either after dinner on Christmas Eve, or in the morning on Christmas Day.

The French New Year's Eve (*le réveillon du Nouvel An*) is often celebrated with friends rather than with family, and it is more of a grown-up occasion. If there are small children, they will be tucked into bed early or allowed to collapse on some couch, but the party is not about them. (Sorry kids.)

Some people go out to dinner on New Year's Eve, but I don't know who they are and I wouldn't want to go with them. In my circle, we are more likely to have a special dinner at someone's house, and possibly go out later, or just push the furniture and party at home*.

Apéritif

A French holiday meal is designed to go on long into the night, so the apéritif phase — pre-dinner drinks with nibbles — will last awhile. Champagne is the typical drink served, but because I am contrarian, I prefer to pick out an alternate sparkling white. At the caviste 's you can ask for a *vin blanc en méthode champenoise* , a white wine produced in the style of Champagne, but from another region.

Raw Scallop Crostini on Pumpernickel Bread

Shellfish is a staple of the French holiday table, and *coquilles Saint-Jacques* (sea scallops) are especially prized. I like to feature them raw in these canapés, an easy and elegant apéritif easily eaten with one hand in a couple of bites.

Fresh Herb and Goat Cheese Quick Bread

There are three reasons you should make this savory quick bread (in French, *cake salé*): one, it freezes beautifully; two, it cuts into bite-size cubes with little mess; and three, it is a quintessential French buffet item. Also: one of my most popular recipes from this blogging year!

A quick win of a recipe, these spiced almonds are perfect for grazing during the apéritif, or to package up in a pretty sachet and bring as a host(ess) gift.

Ready for the sit-down dinner now? Please, take a seat!

A traditional no-cook treat to open the holiday feast is the platter of oysters, freshly delivered from the Atlantic ocean. Order yours from the busy *poissonnier* well in advance; they will shuck them for you at no additional cost (but usually there's a tip jar). Oysters are typically served raw and in the shell, with thin slices of rye bread, salted butter, lemon juice, and shallot vinegar.

It used to be that French people only ate foie gras during the holidays . It was a luxury item, produced traditionally, with care and respect for the animals, and appreciated with reverence. Nowadays, people want it year-round and they want it cheap. This has spawned an industry of mistreated, factory-farmed animals yielding tasteless, fatty foie gras.

My recommendation is to skip the foie gras altogether if you can't be sure it has been produced artisanally and ethically . If, however, you get to visit an independent producer on your travels, or have a solid recommendation for one from a chef or discerning cook, buy a *terrine de foie gras entier mi-cuit* in a jar and savor every bite.

Duck or goose is a matter of preference; the former is more common (ducks are easier to raise) and the flavor more assertive.

Serve your *terrine de foie gras* cold, but not too cold, with toasted bread. *Pain brioché* (think enriched yeast bread such as *challah*) is traditional, I prefer a sourdough loaf to complement the sweetness of good foie gras. Some people insist on serving it with *pain d'épices* (honey spice cake) but that is too cloying for my taste, and I don't think the pairing benefits either. The proper way to eat foie gras is to slice a bite-size piece with your knife, place it on the bread without spreading (sweet heavens, no), and take a bite.

Sigh. Another luxury food item that has been utterly ruined by the consumer's insistence to eat it any old day of the year, but no willingness to pay the proper price for it. The consequence? Factory-farmed salmon pumped full of drugs and chemicals, destroying the environment, and resulting in oily, unsubtle smoked salmon that just tastes of fish and smoke.

I would much rather buy wild salmon and indulge just once a year , buying a couple of thin slices per person and savoring every bite with my eyes closed. (And if that falls outside

Dynamic linking best practices

Joe Nelson (*begriffs*)

In this article we'll learn how to build shared libraries and install them properly on several platforms. For guidance, we'll examine the goals and history of dynamic linking on UNIX-based operating systems.

Content for the article comes from researching how to create a shared library, wading through sloppy conventions that people recommend online, and testing on multiple Unix-like systems. Hopefully it can set the record straight and help improve the quality of open source libraries.

The common UNIX pattern

Version identifiers

API vs ABI

Variance of linker and loader by system

Linkers (ld, lld)

Loaders (ld.so, dyld)

Portable best practices

Example code

The common UNIX pattern

The design typically used nowadays for dynamic linking (in BSD, MacOS, and Linux) came from SunOS in 1988. The paper *Shared Libraries in SunOS* neatly explains the goals, design, and implementation.

The authors' main motivations were saving disk and memory space, and upgrading libraries (or the OS) without needing to relink programs. The resource usage motivation is probably less important on today's powerful personal computers than it was in 1988. However, the flexibility to upgrade libraries is as useful as ever, as well as the ability to easily inspect which library versions each application uses.

Dynamic linking is not without its critics, and isn't appropriate in all situations. It runs a little slower because of position-independent code (PIC) and late loading. (The SunOS paper called it a "classic space/time trade-off.") The complexity of the loader on some systems offers increased attack surface. Finally, upgraded libraries may affect some programs differently than others, for instance breaking those that rely on undocumented behavior.

The link editor and loader

At compile time the link editor resolves symbols in specified libraries, and makes a note in the resulting binary to load those libraries. At runtime, applications call code to map the shared library symbols in memory at the correct memory addresses.

SunOS and subsequent UNIX-like systems added compile-time flags to the linker (ld) to generate – or link against – dynamically linked libraries. The designers also added a special system library (ld.so) with code to find and load other libraries for an application. The pre- main() initialization routine of a program loads ld.so and runs it from within the program to find and load the rest of the required libraries.

As mentioned, applications can take advantage of updated libraries without needing recompilation. Library updates can be classified in three categories:

Implementation improvements for the current interface.
Bug fixes, performance. (Patch release)

New features, additions to the interface. (Minor release)

Backward-incompatible change to the interface or its operation. (Major release)

An application linked against a library at a given major release will continue to work properly when loading any newer minor or patch release. Applications may not work properly when loading a different major release, or an earlier minor release than that used at link time.

Multiple applications can exist on a machine at once, and each may require different releases of a single library. The system should provide a way to store multiple library releases and load the right one for each app. Different systems have different ways to do it, as we'll see later.

Version identifiers

Each library release can be marked with a version identifier (or "version") which seeks to capture information about the library's release history. There are multiple ways to map release history to a version identifier.

The two most common mapping systems are semantic versioning and libtool versioning. Semantic versioning counts the number of releases of various kinds that have happened, and writes them in lexicographic order. Libtool versioning counts distinct library interfaces.

Semantic versioning is written as major.minor.patch and libtool as current:revision:age. The intuition is that current counts interface changes. Any time the interface changes, whether in a minor or major way, current increases. Here's how each system would record the same history of release events:

Event

Semver

Libtool

Initial

1.0.0

Get my new book ready for dessert...now available!

David · David Lebovitz

It's almost ready!

Coming this Fall is the new, completely revised edition of Ready for Dessert: My Best Recipes .

When my publisher told me they wanted a new edition of the book, I decided to revise the book completely, from top to bottom. Ready for Dessert is a compilation of my favorite recipes, so I knew that I wanted to keep my signature Chocolate chip cookies , the Chocolate-cherry biscotti accented with black pepper, and classic Black & white cookies , along with everyone's favorite, the Fresh ginger cake , as well as a tangy Lemon semifreddo , and the recipe for the Coconut layer cake I made for Alice Waters' father on his birthday every year.

Order Ready for Dessert now!

To sweeten the pot, I added brand-new recipes to Ready for Dessert , favorites culled from my kitchen in Paris, including Île flottante (inspired by the version I always order at a favorite local bistro), a very special Riz au lait (rice pudding) topped with crunchy, candied nuts and salted butter caramel sauce, buttery Palets Breton cookies, and my version of the iconic, and irresistible (truly!), Maple tart from Tapisserie in Paris, the pastry shop of the highly-regarded restaurant Septime, so you can make it at home.

One of my favorite pictures (and recipes) from the new edition of Ready for Dessert is the Marjolaine cake. We made several of these cakes for the photo shoot and gave leftovers to the local butcher shop – and now I'm their favorite customer.

Award-winning photographer Ed Anderson , who photographed my books, My Paris Kitchen , Drinking French , and The Perfect Scoop , returned to Paris to shoot the pictures for the book, in my kitchen and backyard, as well as out-and-about in the city. Another bonus was that I got to work with two of my favorite food stylists, Elisabet der Nederlanden and George Dolese . We had a blast shopping in Paris for ingredients, and making the recipes in my kitchen, then eating them as well.

When the food stylists end up devouring your recipes during a photo shoot, that's the highest compliment a cookbook author can have. They bake and cook food all day long, so are picky about what they eat. (And boy, did they eat!) I also invited friends to come by and join us, so you'll find guests shots in the book as well.

The all-new edition of Ready for Dessert is now available at your local independent bookseller and online.

Below are some bookstores and online retailers where you can order the book:

| Amazon | Bookshop.org | Now Serving | Barnes & Noble | Omnivore | Book Larder | Kitchen Arts & Letters | Bold Fork | Books are Magic | Amazon France | Powell's | RJ Julia | Strand | Smith & Son Paris | Amazon UK | Archestratus | Politics and Prose | Vivienne Culinary Books | Book Passage | Elliot Bay | Village Books | East End Books | Indigo Canada | Amazon Australia | Shakespeare and Company Paris |

Hey, Game Devs: The ‘Placeholder Assets’ Excuse For Using AI Is Running Really Thin

Timothy Geigner · *Techdirt*

We’ve been talking a lot of about the use of artificial intelligence lately, for obvious reasons. Many of those conversations have revolved around the video game industry and I’ve been fairly vocal about pushing back against the “all AI is bad everywhere forever” dogma that I see far too often. There are plenty of folks in our community that don’t agree with me on that, and that’s fine. But if the picture you’re getting is that I’m an AI evangelist, that’s simply not true. There are potentially good uses of AI in my view, as well as a whole lot of potential negative outcomes of its use. I’m not blind to that.

And, in the video game industry specifically, one bit of pushback that seems to be sorely needed is on game developers that use generative AI in their games, fail to say so, and then excuse its use as accidental after the fact. That is becoming as common a refrain from game developers as the laughable excuse in trademark instances that is, “Well, I have to be an aggressive jerk about my trademarks or else I lose them.” Neither is true.

The most recent version of this concerns the recent hit launch of *Crimson Desert*. In what is becoming something analogous to the antiquated process by which people who watch golf tournaments on TV looking for missed rules violations could then send into the PGA, which I’ve coined as *McPromptism*, new game releases get put under a microscope by people looking to find AI uses within them. *Crimson Desert* went through this process and, wouldn’t you know it, people found clear uses of AI-generated assets in the game.

The game’s extremely high fidelity and impressive graphics are a big part of the sales pitch, which made it all the more disappointing when players began to come across what appeared to be AI-generated artwork littered throughout the game. In light of the disappointment, developer Pearl Abyss has apologized for including the slop in their game, promising to remove and replace all of it.

“We also acknowledge that we should have clearly disclosed our use of AI,” the *Crimson Desert* account posted on X. “We are currently conducting a comprehensive audit of all in-game assets and are taking steps to replace any affected content. Updated assets will be rolled out in upcoming patches. In parallel, we are reviewing and strengthening our internal processes to ensure greater transparency and consistency in how we communicate with players moving forward.”

Like I said above, this excuse is getting old. Very old. Game developers and publishers will be more than aware at this point that a sizable percentage of the gaming public is very allergic to the use of AI in games, particularly when that use is not acknowledged at the forefront. If placeholder assets generated by AI are to be used at all in the development of a game, it is inexcusable for a developer to not have a process

to remove them in place of human-created art before the game is published. That’s sloppy at best, and a lie of an excuse at worst.

Especially because it’s not like there aren’t other options that have nothing to do with AI.

The practice is becoming more common in AAA developer spaces, but critics argue that setting aside the use of AI in your game, it’s pretty foolish to use temporary assets that don’t call obvious attention to themselves. In games of such massive scale, BRAT-green blocks that scream “DO NOT USE” are much easier to flag than something approximating the final product.

I’m struggling to come up with a counter-argument to that.

I’m still in a place where I think there are valid uses of AI in gaming development. If a dev or publisher wants to explore those uses and, importantly, is upfront about it, there may be a place for that.

But the excuse of laziness when it comes to stripping AI assets out when their use was not intended is lame and needs to go away.

Seville Orange Marmalade

David · David Lebovitz

This time of year brings Seville oranges to the markets in Paris. For the past few years, I kept wondering why they were so hard to find since it's perhaps my favorite of all jams and jellies to make, and eat. But lately, they've been everywhere. And I found myself busy making a lot of marmalade, which was easier since I came up with a brand-new, revolutionary technique which I couldn't wait to share.

Since Seville oranges are rife with seeds, which makes slicing them difficult since you have to keep moving the seeds around with your slippery fingers, while trying to cut the oranges, then finding more, and fishing around deeper inside to extract more, plucking them out, etc... Each Seville orange has perhaps twenty to thirty inside.

So I thought, what if I was to squeeze the juice and seeds out first, strain them, then pour the juice back in? The seeds are precious commodities in jam-making, and get saved and used since they're so high in pectin.

They're wrapped in a sack and cooked with the marmalade giving the marmalade gets a suave, jellied texture. And this simple method, featured in my book *Ready for Dessert*, makes the whole process much easier.

You might be interested to know that Seville Orange Marmalade was created because of an error. Apparently, an Englishwoman in 1700, the wife of a grocer, was stuck with some sour oranges that were bought cheaply from a boat that was carrying them from Seville.

Since there was a storm, they wanted to get rid of their stock of oranges quickly, so the grocer bought them. But they were inedibly sour so his wife decided to try making jam from them, and viola! ...Seville Orange Marmalade was invented.

Adapted from *Ready for Dessert* (Ten Speed)

In my book, I advise letting the cooked oranges and the seeds rest overnight. That's an optional step. If you want to go ahead and finish the marmalade the same day you start it, you can.

Keyword confiture, jam, marmalade, orange

6 Seville oranges (see Note)

1 navel orange

10 cups (2.5L) water

pinch of salt

8 cups (1.6 kg) sugar

1 tablespoon Scotch (optional)

Wash oranges and wipe them dry. Cut each Seville orange in half, crosswise around the equator. Set a non-reactive mesh strainer over a bowl and squeeze the orange halves to remove the seeds, assisting with your fingers to remove any stubborn ones tucked deep within.

Tie the seeds up in cheesecloth or muslin very securely.

Cut each rind into 3 pieces and use a sharp chef's knife to cut the rinds into slices or cubes as thin as possible. Each piece shouldn't be too large (no more than a centimeter, or 1/3-inch in length.) Cut the navel orange into similar-sized pieces.

In a large (10-12 quart/liter) stockpot, add the orange slices, seed pouch, water, and salt, as well as the juice from the Seville oranges from step #1. Bring to a boil, then reduce to a simmer, and cook until the peels are translucent, about 20 to 30 minutes. (At this point, sometimes I'll remove it from the heat after cooking them and let the mixture stand overnight, to help the seeds release any additional pectin. But it's not imperative.)

Stir the sugar into the mixture and bring the mixture to a full boil again, then reduce heat to a gentle boil. Stir occasionally while cooking to make sure it does not burn on the bottom. Midway during cooking, remove the seed pouch and discard.

Continue cooking until it has reached the jelling point, about 218°F degrees (103°C), if using a candy thermometer. I cook this slightly less than other jams and marmalades because the high amount of pectin helps the marmalade set up more stiffly. To test the marmalade, turn off the heat and put a small amount on a plate that has been chilled in the freezer and briefly return it to the freezer. Check it in a few minutes; it should be slightly jelled and will wrinkle just a bit when you slide your finger through it. If not, continue to cook until it is.

Remove from heat, then stir in the Scotch (if using), and ladle the mixture into clean jars. Sometimes I bury a piece of vanilla bean in each jar. (Which is a great way to recycle previously-used or dried-out vanilla beans.)

I don't process my jams, since I store them in the refrigerator. But if you wish to preserve them by canning, you can read more about the process here .

Note : Sour or Seville oranges are called in French oranges amères and are available mid-winter in many other countries around the world as well.

How to Walk on the Trail of Tears

Louise Story · *Atlas Obscura*

There is a place in Prairie Grove, Arkansas, at the quiet corner of Black Nursery Road and East Heritage Parkway, where the ground remembers. Stand there long enough and you begin to feel the weight of it — not the weight of a battle-field monument or a presidential memorial, but something older and more enduring. This was a road where thousands of people were forced to walk because the United States government, under President Andrew Jackson's Indian Removal Act of 1830, had decided their homelands belonged to someone else.

The Trail of Tears National Historic Trail spans more than 5,000 miles across nine states, but you cannot walk it end to end. Much of the route passes through private land, along modern roads, or across waterways, leaving only scattered segments accessible to visitors on foot. What remains open, though, rewards the effort — and northwest Arkansas has some of the most evocative stretches anywhere along the trail.

It's worth knowing what you're standing on here. Prairie Grove sits on the Cherokee Benge Route, one of several overland paths traveled by the tribe in the brutal winter of 1838–1839. But Arkansas was not only Cherokee territory during the removal years. All five of the forcibly displaced nations, the Cherokee, Choctaw, Chickasaw, Creek, and Seminole, traveled through this state on their way to Indian Territory. The routes overlapped, diverged, and converged again across the Arkansas landscape. When you stand at any point along this trail, you are standing on ground that absorbed the suffering of all of them.

The Benge Route passed through Fayetteville and Washington counties before traversing Prairie Grove on its way toward Evansville and the Oklahoma border. Thirteen Cherokee detachments passed through this region. Some arrived near Prairie Grove on Christmas Day, 1838, with snow on the ground. The trail entrance you can walk today follows the same corridor.

The history you know (and some you don't)

The story most Americans learn goes something like this: five sovereign nations were forcibly expelled from their ancestral homelands in the American Southeast and marched westward to Indian Territory in what is now Oklahoma. Thousands died from exposure, disease, and starvation along the way. In the Cherokee language, the journey is called *Nunna daul Tsuny*, "the trail where they cried."

What the standard telling leaves out is equally important, and considerably harder to sit with.

The more prosperous members of all five nations had, in the decades before removal, adopted many of the economic practices of the white planter class surrounding them, including the enslavement of Black people. When the forced marches began, those enslaved people were marched west

too, not as survivors of a tragedy, but as property dragged along by it. Thousands of enslaved Black people, owned by members of all five tribes, were forced to make the journey. They cooked, nursed the sick, and labored throughout. They had no say in any of it.

The story resists easy moral framing. Leaders across the five nations fought their removal with extraordinary legal and political skill, and many of those same leaders enslaved people. This chapter of American history sits at the painful intersection of two of the nation's deepest injustices, entangled and unresolved. The tears on this trail were not shed by one people. They belonged to everyone forced to walk it.

How you can walk it

The Prairie Grove entrance off Black Nursery and East Heritage Parkway offers a quiet, accessible entry point into this history, one that most visitors to northwest Arkansas never find. The surrounding landscape looks deceptively ordinary: Ozark woods, a gravel path, the sounds of a region that has moved on. But the Heritage Trail Partners of Northwest Arkansas have done careful work marking and interpreting these routes, and informational signage helps orient visitors to what they're standing on. Markers call out the path the Cherokee took through these dense woods, the same section passed by the groups that stayed in Cane Hill and those traveling north from Dardanelle. From Prairie Grove, you can follow the Benge Route west toward Evansville and the Oklahoma state line.

Other access points worth seeking out across the trail's nine-state span include Mantle Rock in Kentucky, a sandstone shelter bluff where Cherokee were forced to wait, sometimes for days in brutal cold, before being allowed to cross the Ohio River. The hike there is short and level, about 0.4 miles from the parking area, with signage explaining the site's role in the removal. Fort Smith National Historic Site in western Arkansas marks the point where the Arkansas and Poteau rivers converge, the final crossing into Indian Territory.

Where to learn more

The Museum of the Cherokee Indian in Cherokee, North Carolina tells this story from the perspective of those who survived and those who hid in the Smoky Mountains to avoid removal. It is essential.

The Cherokee Heritage Center in Park Hill, Oklahoma sits near Tahlequah, the endpoint of the trail and the current capital of the Cherokee Nation. It holds archives, oral histories, and a reconstructed 17th-century village that puts the removal into the longer sweep of Cherokee civilization.

The National Park Service maintains the trail's official site at nps.gov/trte, with maps, driving routes, and accessible segment information.

Vegetarian Batch-Cooking for Winter: 1 1/2-Hour Prep, 6 Easy Meals !

clotilde · Chocolate & Zucchini

Buy Clotilde's latest book, The French Market Cookbook !

In addition to planning my menus , I have been doing more and more batch cooking these past few months.

The idea of batch cooking is to block out time one day of the week to prep or cook a bunch of ingredients in advance, which you can draw from and combine for low-effort home-made meals the rest of the week.

It is the shortest path to feeling like a kitchen superhero , saving you brain juice and money along the way.

And today, I am offering you the vegetarian batch cooking plan for winter I've created and test-driven with great success: 1 1/2 hours of prep work for easy 6 meals on subsequent days.

Meal #1: Spiced Pilau Rice with Beets — a comforting, beautiful-looking dish with warm spices.

Meal #2: Stuffed Lumaconi with Butternut Squash — to start the week with a golden and appetizing dish that ticks all the boxes — pasta, silky sauce and melty cheese with an irresistible toasted top layer.

Meal #3: Winter Vegetable Curry — because a warming bowl of curry made with seasonal vegetables is always a good idea.

Meal #4: Roasted Brussels Sprouts with Kimchi served with a poached egg — think miniature cabbages roasted until caramelized, paired with a simple Asian-inspired dressing.

Meal #5: Grated Carrots and Beets with Leftover Curry — for a dinner involving very little time in the kitchen, enjoying your leftover curry with one of the best, and yet oh-so-simple, winter salads around.

Meal #6: Butternut Squash and Lentil Soup — an ayurvedic soup with delicious flavors of fresh ginger, spices and coconut milk.

Below you will find:

– A shopping list (of which you can get a free printable) — everything is available from the organic store or supermarket (they cost around 45€ (\$54) in my store; your mileage may vary),

– Your instructions for the prep work — allow for 1 1/2 hours of prep time,

– Your instructions for each of the six meals — active time ranges from 5 to 15 minutes, time to table from 15 to 45 minutes,

– Suggestions of variations to adapt the plan to various dietary constraints.

If you're new to batch cooking , this plan is an easy and lovely way to dip your toes in and see how deliciously freeing it is. If you're an experienced batch-cook, I hope it provides some ideas to enrich your current practice. And please share your best tips with us!

Related:

[Vegetarian Batch Cooking for Summer](#)

[Vegetarian Batch Cooking for Fall](#)

To make the process super smooth, I recommend these French-made glass containers for storing your preparations (I have two sets; they nest perfectly and take up very little room) and this dual kitchen timer to keep track of two preparations at the same time!

Without further ado, here's your vegetarian batch cooking plan for winter !

This is what you'll make during the 1-hour prep time.

[Your Batch-Cooking Shopping List](#)

[Get your free printable shopping list!](#)

For 4 people:

PRODUCE

☐ 2 butternut squashes , about 900 grams (2 pounds) each (or other firm-flesh winter squash, such as red kuri, acorn, or delicata)

☐ 750 grams (1 2/3 pounds) Brussels sprouts

☐ 750 grams (1 3/4 pounds) raw beets (about 3 medium)

☐ 680 grams (1 1/2 pounds) carrots (about 12 medium)

☐ 230 grams (1/2 pound) potatoes (about 2 medium)

☐ 230 grams (1/2 pound) turnips (about 3 medium)

☐ 1 small head of cauliflower , about 450 grams (1 pound)

☐ 1 small head of lettuce

☐ 1 bunch flat-leaf parsley

☐ 1 bunch cilantro (optional; use just parsley if cilantro is unavailable)

☐ 1 organic lemon

☐ 85 grams (3 ounces) fresh ginger

☐ 3 scallions (aka spring onions, optional)

☐ 2 medium yellow onions

☐ 4 cloves garlic

FBI Tells Senate It's Still Bypassing 4th Amendment By Purchasing Location Data From Third Parties

Tim Cushing · Techdirt

In 2018, the Supreme Court ruled that warrants were needed to obtain cell site location info (CSLI). That decision dealt with law enforcement's warrantless acquisition of 127 days of location data from a cell service provider. As the court saw it, the government was leveraging access to this data to turn cell phones (which has been given heightened protections with the 2014 Riley decision) into government tracking devices, all without having to bother with warrants or deploying government-crafted tracking tech.

The rationale for this 4th Amendment bypass was this: location data slurped up by websites and downloaded apps wasn't exactly the same thing as cell tower location data. Therefore, it could be had without a warrant. In fact, it could be had without bothering the courts at all with a subpoena or any other lighter-weight legal paperwork. The government could just buy this data and sort through it to find what it was looking for. Some third parties were even willing to do the sorting for the right price, freeing the government up to pursue other rights violations.

This option obviously experienced a jump in popularity following the Supreme Court's Carpenter ruling. While the spokespeople constantly stated the agencies they represented (which was pretty much all of them when it came to buying data from data brokers) were super-interested in respecting constitutional rights, they never took the time to explain their "respect" meant constantly testing (or breaking!) the boundaries until court precedent forced them to do otherwise.

In 2023, anti-encryption zealot Christopher Wray was heading the FBI. During the last years of his tenure, he admitted to Congress (or, more specifically, privacy hawk Senator Ron Wyden) that the FBI was — like CBP, ICE, US Secret Service, IRS, and federal prisons — buying up as much location data as it could purchase. Wray insisted this process was "court-authorized," but somehow couldn't find any court documents laying around that would support his claims of authorization.

The government is still buying this data. And it's even more problematic than it was a few years ago, when federal agencies weren't being run by MAGA loyalists and outright racists. Now there's a new wrinkle: the government is delving into ad markets to siphon off RTB (real-time bidding) data that's capable of tying location data to specific devices, even if those hawking the data pretend it's been anonymized.

So, it comes as absolutely no surprise that aspiring frat bro Kash Patel's FBI is doing the same thing that plenty of immigration-focused agencies are already doing . Yet again, it's Senator Wyden demanding answers. And it's Kash Patel answering the questions without honestly engaging with

the questions. Here's Zack Whittaker with the details for TechCrunch :

When asked by U. S. Senator Ron Wyden, Democrat of Oregon, if the FBI would commit to not buying Americans' location data, Patel said that the agency "uses all tools ... to do our mission."

"We do purchase commercially available information that is consistent with the Constitution and the laws under the Electronic Communications Privacy Act — and it has led to some valuable intelligence for us," Patel testified Wednesday.

First, there's the obviously false insistence that this is all very constitutional. Buying location data from data brokers doesn't just violate the spirit of the Supreme Court's Carpenter decision, it's only a letter or three off from violating the letter of the law. When the only difference is where you're obtaining long-term location tracking data, you're just exploiting loopholes rather than actually trying to be "consistent with the Constitution."

The second part is even stupider. When you claim that legally-questionable efforts have "led to some valuable intelligence," you're just saying that the ends justify the means. And if that's the low bar you've set for yourself, you're going to be violating rights regularly because you prefer harvesting data to respecting rights.

This sums up the government's stance concisely:

The FBI claims it does not need a warrant to use this information for federal investigations; though this legal theory has not yet been tested in court.

The government — especially this one — will never err on the side of restraint. It would rather explore the outer edges of legal theory, sacrificing our rights in exchange for more government power. At some point, this legal theory will be tested. But until it is, the government is going to continue to pretend the implications of Carpenter don't apply to anything that hasn't been specifically ruled unconstitutional.

This Chef Is Redefining Cuban Comfort Food From a Kissimmee Food Truck

Sam Lin-Sommer · Atlas Obscura

“All that we have learned has been, as we Cubans say, ‘a golpe.’”

Amanda Melendez is explaining the success of her food truck in Kissimmee, Florida, and it’s quickly becoming clear that her popularity did not come by accident: It was forged out of fire.

“A golpe” literally means “by blows,” and when Melendez says she learned that way, she means that she did so through struggle or sheer force of will.

It would be easy to forget this while salivating over a plate of her *cerdo asado*, or roast pork, the meat falling apart under a gleaming sheet of crispy skin. Served over Cuban rice and beans with pickled onions, fried sweet plantains, and yuca, the knock-out dish makes customers feel at home. So too does warm, graceful service from Melendez and Claudia Mena, her partner in life and in business.

But behind Chef Amanda’s brilliant cooking and impeccable service are two women who have worked tirelessly to build their business from the ground up.

Melendez was born and raised in Matanzas, Cuba in a family that cherished mealtime.

“Food, for us, was more than food,” she recalls. “It was the moment where we would sit together, where we would share our culture.”

Melendez’s grandmother Mirta would prepare delicious meals for her entire extended family: comfort dishes like *carne frita*, or fried meat, and macaroni with pork fill Melendez’s memories of childhood.

“We don’t have that much abundance in Cuba,” Melendez says, “and my grandmother would resolve to feed us with whatever she could get her hands on.” In this way, young Amanda was raised in a culture of culinary innovation.

“In Cuba, if something doesn’t exist, Cubans will invent it to feed their families,” Melendez says.

At age 18, Melendez left the island nation for Miami, where she joined her father, who was already living there at the time.

At first, Amanda wasn’t particularly interested in cooking. As a child, she left the cooking to her grandmother.

In Miami, fate brought her just outside of the kitchen, as a server and a manager. “I worked, like we all do in this country, in gastronomy,” Melendez says. Her first job was in a Salvadorean restaurant, and her second was at a Cuban one. The experiences exposed her to cuisines from across Latin America—even her own.

“I ate foods that people here say are Cuban dishes—that you don’t actually eat in Cuba,” she said, because of a lack of access to ingredients. She points out that *ropa vieja*, a slow-cooked, shredded beef dish that is famous in the United States, is rare in Cuba, because the slaughter and sale of beef is heavily regulated on the island.

With time in the United States, Melendez would not only taste, but also innovate on Cuban dishes that were difficult to obtain back home. At her food truck, she plates a mini-serving of *ropa vieja* on crispy *tostones* (fried green plantains) for a small, punchy bite of Cuba.

A chef is born

Though Amanda’s transition to life in Miami was marked by abundance, she became a cook during a time of desperation: the beginning of the COVID-19 pandemic. With nothing to do, she began to cook in her Miami home, her grandmother guiding her through Cuban classics. “Little by little,” she remembers, “my love for cooking emerged.”

Claudia, who met Amanda while they were both waiting tables, could tell that she was tapping into a passion.

“She pushed me to study it” seriously, Amanda says, and she did, enrolling in night classes at the María Moreno Culinary Institute in Miami. By night, she learned the fundamentals of French cooking, and by day she continued working at a Cuban restaurant in Miami.

But that hustle was not paying off; the pandemic killed much of the business at her day job, so she needed to look for other opportunities. Again, her loved ones saw her talent, and encouraged her to nurture it.

“My brother-in-law told me, ‘You cook well, why don’t you start a meal prep business?’”

Amanda took to preparing lunches in her home kitchen that Claudia would deliver to clients around Miami. Over the course of several years, her business grew from 7 clients to 80, and she had to start cooking in a ghost kitchen to handle the volume. While at school she worked a punishing schedule: she would wake up at 3 A. M., cook until around 7, take a nap, then buy groceries for the next day before heading to classes from 7 P. M. to 11 P. M. at night.

While Amanda was at school, the couple heard about an opportunity to buy a food truck, and they jumped on it. At first, they used the truck as a ghost kitchen.

In 2024, Amanda graduated from Maria Moreno with a degree in culinary arts. She and Claudia continued with their catering business in Miami, but they dreamed of leaving the city so they could show Amanda’s cooking—Cuban food with global influences—to a non-Cuban public.

Amanda’s father lives in Orlando, and on a trip to visit him, Amanda and Claudia were impressed by the area’s vibrant food-truck scene. They wanted to become a part of it.

Sieboldhuis in Leiden, Netherlands

Atlas Obscura

While not well known in most places, Filipp Franz von Siebold is a famous name in the Netherlands and perhaps surprisingly in Japan as a well respected 19th-century doctor and botanist.

The German scientist came to Japan in 1823 where he worked in Dejima Island and later in a medical school in the Nagasaki countryside. During his time there he discovered and catalogued many new plant species, and found ways to transport them to the Dutch Indies, and even the Netherlands where some of them still grow today in the Herbarium Botanicum .

In 1829 Siebold was arrested for smuggling maps and placed under house arrest for about a year before he was banished and sent back to the Netherlands with an enormous amount of plants, books, local items, and maps.

Once back in the Netherlands he set up a large curiosity cabinet and began teaching Japanese language, culture, and medicine at the university. This building has largely remained preserved to this day, with the original artifacts and books still on display.

The upper floor of the building became an exhibition space for rotating Japan related exhibitions.

10 Absolutely Ingenious Ways to Open Wine Without a Corkscrew

Heather Fishel · WonderHowTo

Unless you like boxed wine, your wine bottles are going to either be sealed with a cork or a screw cap, the latter of which should not be frowned upon, especially if it's white wine. However, most wineries still prefer corks over screw caps, and that means you'll need a corkscrew. If your corkscrew is missing, or don't have it on hand, don't worry —there are many different ways to open the bottle without getting tiny cork crumbs in the wine. Don't Miss: 50+ Clever & Crazy Ways to Open a Beer Bottle1. Use Some ToolsAs long as you can find a toolbox, you can get a bottle of wine open with a screw, screwdriver, and hammer. Stick the screw into the cork, then use the screwdriver to screw it in further. Leave about one inch of the screw out of the cork.

Then, grab your hammer and, using the end (not the head), you can pull both the screw and cork out of the bottle itself. (This works best with bigger screws with large threads.) Yumi Sakugawa/WonderHowToYou can also use a bunch of nails ...more

My 50-State Quest: Gravette, Arkansas

Louise Story · Atlas Obscura

The best road trip moments are the unplanned ones — when something catches your eye and you just pull over. That's what happened in Gravette, Arkansas, a town of a few thousand that calls itself "Home-town America" on its water tower. I spotted a U. S. Air Force jet mounted in a town park and did a U-turn. What I found was a whole compressed world: a memorial to Captain Field Kindley, the third-ranking American ace of World War I, who grew up on those very streets and died in a plane crash in 1920 at just 24 — after surviving the war.

Nearby, a pentagon-shaped stone dedicated by Boy Scout Troop 117 read "May They Never Be Forgotten." And right next to it all: a time capsule sealed in 1993, not to be opened until 2043. Two minutes off the highway, and suddenly I was standing at the intersection of heroism, grief, and a small town's stubborn faith that someone in the future will care what they left behind. That's the thing about pulling over: wonder isn't waiting at the destination. It's hiding in plain sight along the way.

How far are you on your 50-state quest? And any recommendations for where I should go next? Send me your thoughts! I can't wait to hear from you.

Lasagna Soup, Plus Other Yummy Ways to Use Lasagna Noodles

Naomi Imatome-Yun · WonderHowTo

Lasagna, that layered, creamy baked pasta dish, is a lovely comfort food that's great for a crowd. But if you've ever made it, you know you're usually left with some leftover lasagna noodles. (Although that's always better than the frustration of running out of noodles while you're still making a traditional lasagna.) Still, what do you do when you're left with a bowlful of the wide ribbons? Guess what? There's no rule that you can only use lasagna noodles to make a layered pasta dish. Those frilly wide noodles are good in soups, salads, and almost any other pasta recipe you can dream up. All you need to do is slice them into the width and shape you wish, and you have a blank canvas to season and dress up any way you wish. I like to cook the lasagna noodles first before slicing them.

Although the 'broken lasagna' pieces look rustically delicious, it's hard to cook the pasta correctly if you don't break it up into a uniform size. How to make lasagna soup Lasagna soup has all the flavors ...more

Air Force jet mounted in a town park and did a U-turn.

Louise Story

How to Play ‘I’m Yours’ by Jason Mraz on Baritone Ukulele

getexcellent · WonderHowTo

Learn to play one of the most feel-good ukulele songs ever — Jason Mraz’s “I’m Yours” — arranged for baritone ukulele. These step-by-step video lessons walk you through the whole song with tabs, chord breakdowns, strumming patterns, and fingerpicking tips to help you master every section. While the lesson is great for intermediate players, beginners can follow along with some practice. Whether you’re playing solo or serenading someone special, this baritone uke version sounds great and feels even better to play. ☑ Watch all three versions below to get started — from YouTubers Edwin Parsons, Abby Lyons, and ukeplay-alongs. Abby also has a booklet of printable lead sheets you can download, which includes “I’m Yours” and nine other popular songs.

Hot deal: Kala MK-B Makala Baritone Ukulele Bundle with Gig Bag, Tuner, Strap, Aquila Strings, Online Lessons, Austin Bazaar Instructional DVD, and Polishing Cloth (\$109.99) ‘I’m Yours’ uke play-along with Abby Lyons’I’m Yours’ uke lesson with ...more

The Digital Fellowship is your foot in the door to the future of news

Guardian Staff · Guardian Developer Blog

A developer in the Fellowship Scheme shares his experiences of his first year at the Guardian

I clearly remember my early days in the Guardian’s Digital Fellowship as a mixture of excitement and being totally overwhelmed. I had joined the editorial tools team, which builds all our digital tools for our journalists. At morning stand-up people were mentioning more acronyms than I thought I could ever remember. Like many of the fellows from previous years I don’t have a computer science degree, or even a STEM background, and getting thrown into a department with more than 80 engineers can be intimidating!

Fast forward a couple of months I had written my first AWS lambda , contributed to various projects and was regularly deploying production code unsupervised. The value of the fellowship lies in the fact that while you are given the time to develop your skills independently – you might choose to attend workshops run by other members of the department, learn a new framework and give a talk about it or work on a personal project and present it on the amazing Hack Day – from day one you are treated as an integral part of your team. That means that you get your hands dirty on real projects, learning and improving at an incredible pace.

Continue reading...

If You're Hungry When Sick, It Might Be Less Severe—But More Contagious

Sheryl Wood · WonderHowTo

Lack of appetite often signals a cold or flu. Eating can be the last thing we want to do when we have a sore throat or are too fatigued or achy to even get out of bed. When hungry, we don't feel as strong as when we are well fed—and we more than likely aren't as strong. The scientific world used to think that's how bacteria worked, too. When bacteria had ample nutrients available—when we were feeding that cold instead of starving a fever—they were healthier and would multiply, flourish, and keep on infecting. But a provocative new study published today in *Cell* has found a tricky *Salmonella typhimurium* bacteria that has evolved a mechanism that keeps humans it infects healthier—and makes the bacteria weaker. Of course, there's more to the story, and it actually works to the bacteria's advantage.

The Basics of Salmonella
Salmonella infections can cause severe intestinal distress in humans and can be easily transmitted by ingesting food contaminated with the bacteria or by inadvertently ...more

Pistachio Ganache (with White Chocolate and Pistachio Butter)

Lindsay Landis · Love and Olive Oil

This ultra creamy, vibrant green pistachio ganache is made with white chocolate and naturally flavored with real pistachio butter for a sweet, nutty, and earthy pistachio flavor that's perfect for a wide variety of fillings and frostings for cakes, cookies, and pastries.

With only three main ingredients and a mere 20 minutes of active time (plan on an hour or two for it to set, but it can also be made further ahead of time), this homemade pistachio ganache is a true showstopper, and easily adaptable depending on the exact consistency and flavor you desire.

My pistachio obsession is showing no signs of abating any time soon.

After making a truly otherworldly whipped pistachio ganache to top my exquisite raspberry pistachio frangipane tart , I decided that a standalone pistachio ganache recipe was probably a good idea, as it makes such an incredibly versatile frosting or filling.

This recipe is for a standard soft-set pistachio ganache (perfect for truffle filling or macarons), but it's easy enough to turn it into a whipped ganache by just adding additional cream and then whipping it to silky smooth, airy perfection the next day.

What to do with it?

Other than eat it with a spoon, you mean? That's a great question!

Ganache is truly one of the most flexible fillings in the pastry world, and you can use this pistachio one in just about any recipe that calls for chocolate ganache .

I used it to fill some gorgeously green truffles (seriously, the contrast of the rich, dark chocolate with the sweet pistachio is a revelation). If I have the time to make a batch of chocolate or pistachio macarons, I might use what's left to fill those (did I mention I made multiple batches of this?)

But truffles and macarons are only the beginning.

(more...)

10 Ways to Whiten Clothes Without Using Any Bleach

Heather Fishel · WonderHowTo

Whites are the hardest color to keep looking bright and new after just a few months' time. Your sweat and oils quickly become stains, and colors from other clothes will eventually bleed into the fabric, discoloring your bright whites into something merely whitish. But before you reach for the bleach, the ultimate chemical cleaner, try some of these safer, less-toxic DIY solutions out instead. Don't Miss: [How to Remove Sweat Stains from Clothes](#) Don't Miss: [How to Remove Almost Any Stain Using Alcohol](#) 1. Use a Citrus Soak Instead of sending your white laundry into the washer to get clean, whiten your yellowed items with a citrus soak. Martha Stewart recommends boiling your whites with lemons or lemon juice, turning up the heat until the water bubbles and then letting them soak for about an hour.

You can also add lemon juice to your regular wash cycle and achieve similar results. Emily/Holistic Squid 2. Brighten with the Power of the Sun Once your whites are freshly washed and wet, skip ...more

This Thanksgiving, You Can Have Your Booze & Eat It, Too

Nick & Bay Nigro · WonderHowTo

To some people, Thanksgiving is merely quality time with family and friends that they can't get throughout the rest of the year. To others, it's that one time when it's okay to be a greedy hog and get hammered all weekend long. In that spirit of eat-and-drink-until-you-drop, we've found some of the best Thanksgiving Day recipes that combine your favorite traditional dishes with your alcohol of choice. We're talking appetizers, main dishes, and desserts with wine, hard cider, vodka, and more — there's something for everyone! These, of course, will be no substitution for all that wine and beer you'll be drinking throughout your holiday break, so make sure to stock up accordingly. 1. Cheddar & Hard Cider Fondue Fondue is one of the most amazing things in the entire culinary world — especially when it comes to seasonal fondue.

Make the Food Network's version of cheddar and hard cider fondue and literally dip everything you can in it before it gets eaten up: sausages, bread, vegetables, ...more

The Buried Church Beneath Musée Rude in Dijon, France

Atlas Obscura

How to Make a Balloon-Powered Paper Plate Racer

Osas Obaiza · WonderHowTo

With a little spare time and a few items you can find around the house, you can make your own balloon-powered paper car. This is a great and easy DIY project that's perfect for competitive kids. All you'll need to get started is: Cardboard Straws Scotch tape Marker Paper plates Scissors BBQ skewers (any straight stick would work) The paper plate will act as the body of the racer. You will need to fold it into a triangle and then use the straws as axles for the wheels a little later. Make sure to tape down the plate in the middle and front so it doesn't unfold. Once the axles are tapped down, use the cardboard to cut out wheels for your racer. With your wheels ready, make a hole in the center of each wheel and place the skewers into the center. Make sure it is as central as possible to avoid an uneven ride.

Now place the skewers into the straws and connect the wheels to the ends. Your racer is almost complete. Tape the two axles on the bottom of the paper plate and then attach your ...more

How to Make Perfectly Fluffy Mashed Potatoes Without Adding More Butter or Milk

Karen Ahn · WonderHowTo

Mashed potatoes are universally beloved, and for a good reason — they're cheap, tasty, and relatively easy to make. What's more, they're adaptable to just about every dietary regimen, whether you're vegan, gluten-free, or lactose-intolerant. And they're a staple for holidays such as Thanksgiving. There are all kinds of recipes and theories about how to make a perfectly fluffy mash. However, many of them involve elaborate amounts of butter, cream, or other assorted dairy products. Turns out, there are astonishingly easy and cheap ways to get your mashed taters to a perfectly fluffy and cloud-like state without adding unnecessary calories to the recipe. Joe Gough/Shutterstock Add a Leavening Ingredient The answer to perfect mashed potatoes? Sprinkle a pinch or two of baking powder atop your potatoes before you start mashing them.

Just make sure your baking powder is fresh. Gabrielle Taylor/WonderHowTo Baking powder and baking soda are both chemical leaveners that make batters rise, which ...more

How to Make a Football-Shaped Pull-Apart Cake

Alessa · WonderHowTo

Beneath the elegant calm of the museum lies something far older and far less orderly: the archaeological remains of an 11th-century church that refuses to fully disappear. The crypt is not polished or prettified. Instead, it reveals raw foundations, fractured columns, and worn stone outlines that trace the ghostly footprint of the original structure.

This underground space once belonged to the Church of Saint-Étienne, one of the earliest religious centers in Dijon . Time, revolutions, and urban reinvention dismantled the church above, but its bones endured.

Rough stone arches curve overhead like ribs. The air is cool and still, carrying the quiet dignity of something that has outlived its purpose yet refuses to vanish. Informational panels help decode the fragments, but the true magic lies in the unfinished feeling. Nothing here tries to impress. It simply persists.

The result is a rare encounter with a building in reverse, not restored to glory, but preserved mid-disappearance. It's less a monument than a memory made visible.

How to Silence Your Obnoxiously Squeaky Bed with 4 Easy MacGyver Style Fixes

Gabrielle Taylor · WonderHowTo

Any living creature will die if deprived of sleep for long enough. The longest documented occurrence of a person not fully sleeping and surviving is only 11 days. There is a rare disease where deep sleep is never achieved, affecting roughly 100 people worldwide. Patients usually only survive between 6 to 18 months after the onset of chronic insomnia, and only 3 to 9 months in a parasomnia state without any real REM sleep. Even if you're not suffering from chronic insomnia, minor sleep deprivation affects your weight, mood, mental health, and even your genes. It's tough to avoid the occasional sleepless night due to stress, not feeling well, or noisy neighbors, but one thing that should never keep you up is a squeaky bed. ShutterstockAnnoying and potentially embarrassing.

Here are a few quick and simple fixes using stuff you probably have around the house so you can sleep in peace, and help your neighbors sleep, if that's the case. Tighten the JointsSometimes, fixing a squeaky bed is ...more

8 Simple Tweaks to Transform Your Boring Pumpkin Pie

Nick & Bay Nigro · WonderHowTo

What kind of cake goes best with the Super Bowl? If you guessed a football-shaped cake, you guessed right. In this video recipe, Betty Crocker shows you how to whip up a super easy American football cake that's also a pull-apart cake, because Super Bowl fans don't have time to slice and serve. Instead of a traditional cake, this cake is made out of cupcakes, which is where the pull-apart part comes from. Best of all, if you've got all of the right ingredients already, it'll only take 5 minutes to make, making it a cinch to make during any pregame show. More details on the recipe can be found here.

More Game Day Foods: Gatorade-Infused Treats for a Super Bowl PartyBuffalo Chicken Pizza Beer Dip: The Ultimate Super Bowl Snack5-Minute Super Bowl Snacks for the Win5 Easy Velveeta-Free Cheese Dips for Your Super Bowl Party-How to Make Sinfully Delicious Buffalo Wings (That Are Low on ...more

How to Tell if Your 'Expired' Eggs Are Still Good to Eat

Gabrielle Taylor · WonderHowTo

Many people rely on the date printed on an egg carton to decide when to toss the dozen, but sell-by and best-by dates are quality guidelines — not safety deadlines. If you've been pitching eggs solely because of the date on the carton, you may be wasting perfectly good food. Eggs can stay tasty well past those printed dates. According to the US Department of Agriculture (USDA), eggs kept refrigerated at 40°F (4°C) or below remain perfectly safe for at least three to five weeks after the pack date and often longer. Before you find out the hard way, here are a few reliable at-home tests that let you gauge freshness (and, by extension, quality) with much more confidence. Your eyes and nose are the best tools for spotting spoilage in meats, produce, and herbs — it's pretty obvious when something's moldy or stinky.

Eggs are trickier because you can't see or smell the inside until you crack the shell. Fortunately, a few simple tests reveal whether an intact egg is still good. The ...more

How to Prevent Carved & Uncarved Pumpkins from Rotting

Tara Redfield · WonderHowTo

Pumpkin pie is a symbol of autumn, and it's the traditional dessert to whip up for your fam when Thanksgiving Day arrives. But year after year of the same old thing can be a total bore if you're not a strict traditionalist. So, we found 8 unique ways to make that pie a little less snooze-fest and a little more interesting. Don't Miss: Why You Should Always Keep Canned Pumpkin in Your Pantry 1. Brûlée It, BabyYep—we want you to brûlée that bad boy. Not only does a brûlée pumpkin pie taste like a gift from the Thanksgiving gods, the burnt sugar crust on top of your well-loved pumpkin custard is a showstopper. Check out Bon Appetit's recipe for brûléed bourbon maple pumpkin pie (bonus liquor, woohoo!) for the full scoop. 2. Mascarpone Whipped CreamEvery dessert can be instantly better with some good old-fashioned whipped cream.

However, if you're looking to change it up, try making it with mascarpone: it's both airy and sturdy, thanks to the addition of the cheese. Stress Baking has an ...more

Pumpkin carving and decorating is a favorite October pastime. After you've carved an amazing design or face into a pumpkin or two, you want to show it off through your window or set it out on your porch for the neighbors to see. But, without knowing the tricks to save your holiday pumpkins, they can turn slimy, moldy, and mushy in as little as three days. Don't let that happen — let everyone see your original masterpiece, not a mushy, sunken, sad version. This is your jack-o'-lantern ... right before it starts to grow mold. So, we here at WonderHowTo scoured the web to discover all the tips and tricks to find out how to make your carved and uncarved pumpkins go the distance — to Halloween and beyond! Read on to find out what worked best, what didn't, and how to have the best looking jack-o'-lanterns in your 'hood.

Just keep in mind that if you live in an area with high humidity or lots of rain, your carved pumpkins won't last as long as those in dryer environments. These ...more

Parsing: the merit of strictly typed JSON

Max Duval · Guardian Developer Blog

Dealing with content that keeps changing can lead to bugs on users' devices that are hard to reproduce. By precisely describing the shape of the content using types and ensuring it matches, exceptions can be avoided and users shown helpful messages when errors occur. This post will illustrate how this can be achieved with standard web technologies.

The programming language of the web is JavaScript (JS), but its lack of static typing is the top pain point raised from the 2023 State of JS survey. We rely on TypeScript (TS) to get a strong structural type analysis of our code, as mentioned in our article on [standardisation](#). Static typing helps prevent runtime errors on our users' machines. However, to ensure that no `TypeError` ever appears, we need to avoid the loose `'any'` type, which is an escape hatch designed to opt-out of TS' static analysis.

JavaScript Object Notation (JSON) is widely used as a data exchange format for REST APIs. Its syntax is compatible with JS, with only a subset of the language's primitives: objects, arrays, strings, numbers and nulls. Simple objects can be turned into a string with `JSON.stringify` and turned back into an object with `JSON.parse`, making it an adequate choice for many uses. We use it for powering our comments, new live blog updates, football match scores, weather, most read and other features of the website and Apps.

[Continue reading...](#)

8 Last Minute Fixes for Common Thanksgiving Cooking Disasters

Yumi Sakugawa · WonderHowTo

Lumpy gravy? Gluey mashed potatoes? Dry turkey meat? So many things can go wrong when you are bestowed the honor (and burden) of cooking Thanksgiving dinner. Thankfully, some culinary mishaps that you encounter in the kitchen can be reversed or craftily disguised right before your guests sit down to eat. Below, you'll learn must-know Turkey Day tips for a smooth cooking adventure. Examples include fast-thawing your turkey the morning of, fixing burned, undercooked, or dry turkey, making gravy smoother, fixing undercooked stuffing, and patching pumpkin pie cracks. These are just a few of the clever hacks you might have to use to rescue Thanksgiving dinner, and hopefully, they'll be all you need.

Don't Miss: [How to Cook the Perfect Turkey for Thanksgiving Dinner](#) Got your own heroic stories of how you fixed your own Thanksgiving cooking mistakes? Share with us in the comments below. **Don't Miss:** [10 Easy-to-Make Centerpieces for Thanksgiving Dinner](#) Follow WonderHowTo on Facebook, Twitter, ...more

We rely on TypeScript (TS) to get a strong structural type analysis of our code, as mentioned in our article on standardisation.

Max Duval

How to Heat Your Home in an Emergency Without Gas Using Flower Pots & Candles

Gabrielle Taylor · WonderHowTo

Not having power can make everyday tasks really difficult if you're unprepared. You have to find new ways to do things like cook dinner and charge your devices, and if it happens during the winter, you also have to figure out how to heat your home. If you don't have a battery-powered heater, you can make a simple emergency space heater with a few tea candles and two flower pots, one small and one large. Dylan Winter made this one with a metal baking pan, but you could use just about any heat resistant container. Dylan Winter/YouTubeWinter put four tea lights in the baking pan and covered them with the smaller flower pot. He used the metal casing from a tea light to cover the hole in the flower pot, which causes the heat to be trapped inside so the pot gets warm.

The large pot then goes over the small one with nothing covering the hole to create a convective heat transfer. Each set of candles should last about four hours, and the heater produces enough heat for one room. If you've got ...more

After Halloween Guide: How to Remove Makeup, Face Paint, Fake Blood & Body Glue from Skin & Clothing

Gabrielle Taylor · WonderHowTo

Becoming someone else for Halloween is a lot of fun, but it can take a ton of tools to accomplish. An elaborate costume can require you to slather yourself in all kinds of makeup, paints, and glues, and putting it on is only half the work. The real fun starts when the party's over, and you have to remove it all. Mat McDermott/Flickr Every product has different ingredients, so the way you wash it off will differ from one to another. Some are as easy as washing your face, and others may require you to use something a little more potent than water. But before you try anything... Read the Label FirstAs the FDA suggests, the best place to start is to read the label on a product and see if it has instructions for how to wash it off. If they tell you what to use on the bottle, that's probably your best bet.

But some of them don't give you any hints as to what will remove that particular type of gunk from your skin. As annoying as it is, going to bed in your costume makeup just isn't an ...more

Urartian Tomb of Yerevan in Yerevan, Armenia

Atlas Obscura

The Urartian (Biaynian) tomb of Yerevan is located at 34 Arshakunyats Avenue, within the premises of the former “Autoaggregate” factory, now part of the “Yerevan Mall” shopping center. Its discovery dates back to 1984 during construction activities. The excavation and study of this site were conducted by the Institute of Archeology and Ethnography of the Armenian Soviet Socialist Republic, led by archaeologist Leonid Biyagov and architect Armine Kanetsyan.

To preserve this historical monument, a restoration project was initiated in 1984 under the supervision of architect Vladimir Chagharyan, followed by meticulous construction efforts.

Remarkably, the mausoleum has been well-preserved, maintaining its original condition. It spans an area of 12 square meters and is an underground rectangular structure oriented in a north-south direction. The tomb’s floor is adorned with finely crafted black, red, and dark brown tuff slabs, beneath covered with crypts. The walls, constructed of hewn tuff, stand five rows tall. The ceiling consists of tuff rocks with substantial coverage.

Inside the tomb, niches are carved into the walls, containing cremated urns filled with crushed human, animal, and avian bones, alongside a large urn adorned with bull-headed figurines, a jar, a lamp, bowls, and other artifacts. Among the findings are bronze snakehead bracelets, pottery fragments, parts of horse bridles, rivets, an iron sword, a knife, daggers, agate beads, a satyr seal depicting a griffin and a crescent moon, and a bronze chalice embellished with a ram’s head, as well as three bronze belts, among other items.

The discovered artifacts possess significant historical, cultural, and artistic value, representing one of the most opulent burials identified so far from the Kingdom of Van. The collection indicates that the mausoleum likely belonged to the Urartian elite.

Adjacent to the tomb, an Early Bronze Age stone box burial was also discovered. Pottery from the early 1st millennium BC was found in the surrounding area. These materials are currently housed in the Erebuni Museum in Yerevan.

Presently, the preservation of the mausoleum is overseen by the management of “Yerevan Mall.” By the way, the interior design of the mall is decorated with Urartian cuneiform engravings and showcases statuettes from the Urartian period.

ANALYSIS

IN BRIEF

Tom Richards, Guardian Developer Blog: Pinboard is a discussion and asset sharing tool (or rather tool within other tools) which is gradually transforming how the news room communicate as news stories move through the various phases of the production process

This is part three of three (part one and part two).

Continue reading...

Dahlia Ambrose, Light Stalking: Minimalism is an art and it can be also applied to all genre in photography - minimal portraits, minimal landscapes, minimal street photos, etc. In landscape photography, when you use minimalism as a compositional tool, the framing becomes very intentional and you focus on a particular element (which may be your subject) or two, the light, shapes, form, etc. Doing this can add a mood or emotion to your landscapes.

Here are 25 simple yet striking photos that portray minimalism in landscapes.

The post [25 Simple Yet Striking Photos That Portray Minimalism In Landscapes](#) appeared first on [Light Stalking](#) .

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